

AUGMENT ME

Augmented reality is set to change not just your perception of the world, but who you are...

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You've already scanned our cover and seen the augmentation we did to it. If not, do so now, because this intro sort of depends on you doing so, in order to be taken in context.

Back? Impressed? Don't be. What we did, is absolutely nothing compared to what you will see all around you in just a few short years. Reality, as you know it today, needs an upgrade, and it's going to get it a lot sooner than you think.

AR vs. VR

So what's the big difference? It's all the unreal and surreal and anything but "real", why differentiate? To start with, VR (virtual reality) as the name suggests is virtual. It's by definition, not real. So if you want to experience the feeling of standing on top of Mount Everest, looking around you, VR will be able to take you there and maybe even blow cold air up your shorts to give you actual shivers... it's about letting you live out your imagination. You will soon have VR movies - imagine Jurassic Park, but where you get a personalised experience of the events occurring, because each one of you is free to roam the virtual world and approach the action

from a different perspective! That's VR; it's a show! Games, movies, things that you can experience sitting in a chair.

The new idiot box, and some suggest it's just one more way for humanity to sit on it's @\$ getting fat and unhealthy. Some would go as far as pitching the two against one another in a battle for survival, but we think this is far fetched. There are people who believe that AR is better, because it makes you want to go out and do stuff, not just sit in a chair. There are others who argue that Facebook bought Oculus VR because they wanted to stay competitive with Google Glass, how-

ever we think that's akin to comparing apples to red sneakers! Google Glass will enhance your reality, and Oculus will enhance your virtuality, and you're going to want both! The couch potatoes aren't getting fat because of technology, they're just choosing the technologies that allow them to stay lazy... at Digit we never blame the technology, only the users!

Augmented Reality (AR), however, is taking what's real, and enhancing it using technology to almost add additional senses while perceiving the "real world". This enhancement could be just simple information, or more complex layers on

top of what you see. Think Superman's X-ray vision to be able to see what's happening on the other side of a building...

AR Apps

Many of you have been using AR apps for some time now. Most of these take physical products or images and overlay them with information that you can interact with. Although even simple things such as



A contact lens plus glasses solution from Innovega (innovega-inc.com) looks really good already